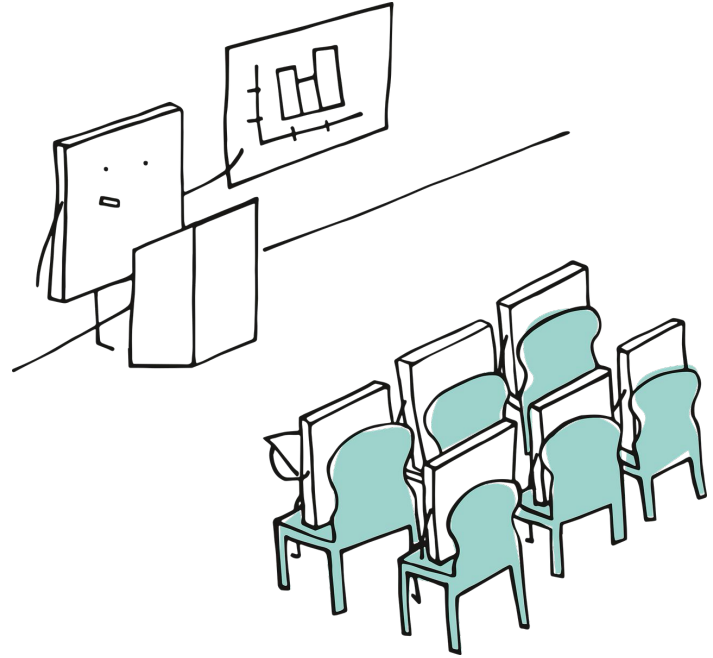


Lesson 14: Expository writing

HS192 Introduction to Writing - 2
@ IITGN, 2025-26



Today's learning objective

Practice expository writing

Academic essay

Expository (Explanatory) writing

Argumentative writing

The main aim of an academic essay is to **inform** or **persuade** readers of an idea based on evidence.

You must have a clear thesis statement.

You should use sources to provide relevant evidence support your thesis statement.

Expository writing

“explains something to the audience.”

(AWL, https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/general_writing/the_writing_process/thesis_statement_tips.html)

- Expository/explanatory writing is pervasively used for various media including informative blogs, magazine/news articles, and TED talks.
- In academia, it is used for scientific reports, such as a summary of your experiment, stating what you did and what you found out.
- It is also pervasively used in business and industry to give information to your customer, boss, employer, and donors.

Features of good expository writing

Fact-based: Personal thoughts and opinions are reduced.

Reader-friendly: “An expository writer can’t assume that potential readers have prior knowledge or understanding about the information.”

Informative: It is organized and presented in the way of maximize the reader’s understanding of the information.

Clear: It delivers highly relevant information straightforwardly and precisely.

Types of information to be explained

- Fact
- Concept
- Principle
- Procedure
- Process

Facts

- Basic information (“Component”); Building blocks of other content types

DNA is made up of building blocks: A, T, G and C

An enzyme called DNA polymerase begins replicating the DNA...

- Mostly taught with concepts, procedures, processes or principles

Consider organizing facts effectively using charts, tables, or other graphic displays.

Concepts

Class of items known by a common noun.

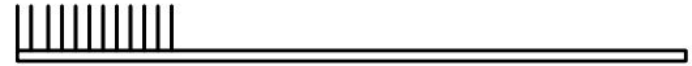
Include multiple specific examples, which share common, “defining”, features and peripheral, parametric, features.

What is a Toothbrush?

Definition

A toothbrush is a small brush with a long handle, usually made of plastic, used exclusively for brushing teeth.

Example



Non-example



A hair brush (shown) is much larger and it would not fit into your mouth.

Graphics of (non)examples help eliminate confusion

Definition highlights key feature(s)

Principles

Guidelines or criteria that direct us in given situations; they help us perform effectively.

Principles of Giving Effective Feedback (Employee Development/Coaching):

Provide feedback that is balanced, objective, specific, and supportive (BOSS).

Procedure

Clearly defined steps that result in the achievement of a task (“smaller things that one is expected to do”; do this, then do that)

How to Brush Your Teeth

Introduction Now that you recognize the equipment you will need and we have discussed when you will need to brush your teeth, let's see how you brush.

Action Table Here are the steps to follow to brush your teeth.

<i>Step</i>	<i>Action</i>
1	Wet toothbrush with water from tap.
2	Apply about 1/2" of toothpaste on bristles.
3	Hold handle of brush and move bristles up and down against teeth.
4	Open mouth and brush back teeth.
5	Use glass of water to rinse out mouth.
6	Wash off toothbrush and return equipment.

Demonstration Follow along as your instructor demonstrates the steps.

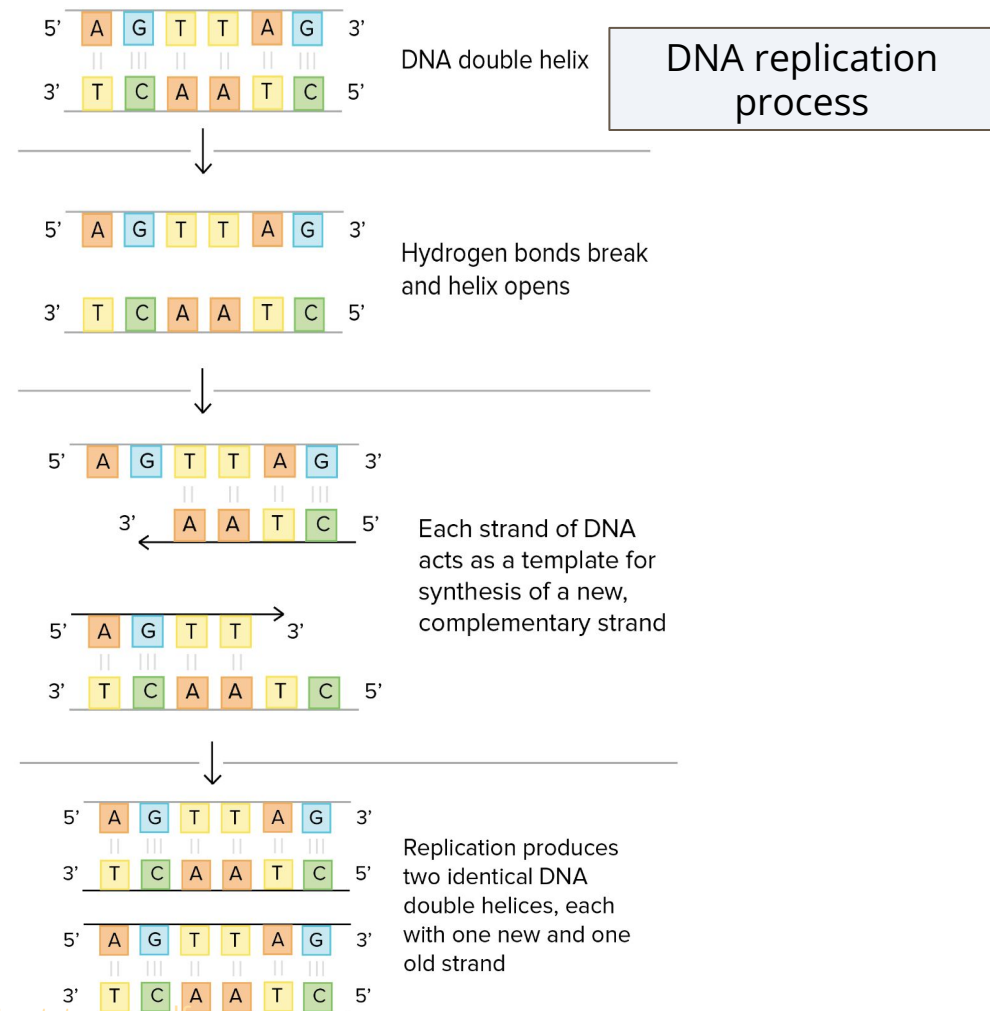
When to Brush Your Teeth

Guidelines The following table describes situations when you should brush your teeth.

<i>IF...</i>	<i>AND...</i>	<i>THEN...</i>
You have just eaten	Your brush and paste are handy	Brush your teeth
	Your brush and paste are NOT handy	Rinse out mouth and brush later
You are going to bed	You have NOT brushed for four hours	Brush your teeth
	You have brushed in the last four hours	Wait until morning

Process

Descriptions of how things work ("what happens next")



Fact, concept, procedure, process, or principle

What types are they of?

- Spaceships and space shuttles—What are they and what do they do?
- How to enjoy Indian Chinese food to the fullest

Group activity

- We just learned five types of topic for explanation: fact, concept, principle, procedure, and process.
- Did you understand all clearly? Try to explain them further to be more understandable by you and your classmates. Consider the following questions:
 - What are more examples of facts, concepts, principles, procedures, and processes?
 - What is the difference between procedures and processes?
- For new sources, check their credibility as we learned.

Debrief

- Share your examples of
 - Fact
 - Concept
 - Principle
 - Procedure
 - Process
- How procedure is different from process? Is “making a cup of coffee” a process or a procedure?
- What decent sources did you discover for the information?

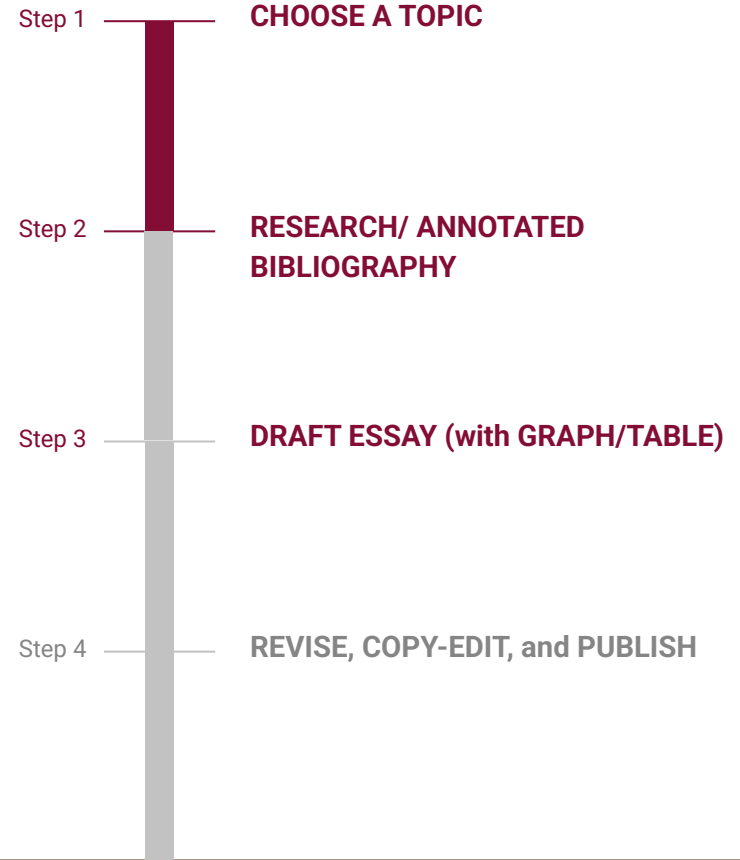
Further categories of topic to be explained

Oftentimes, two or more components are mixed

- **Combination** of two (e.g., fact + principle)
 - The best tourist spots near to my hometown and how to make the most of the trip
- **Comparing** two facts/concepts/processes/procedures
 - Boiling and evaporation: What are they and how are they different?
- Facts/concepts/processes/procedures + **analytic prediction**
 - Recent match results of Manchester City and Girona in their domestic leagues and City's possibility to participate in Champions League 23-24.

What steps are we going to take?

- Choose a topic to research.
- Conduct research online/ offline, and evaluate the quality and relevance of the sources.
 - Synthesize your arguments into an annotated bibliography.
 - Visualize relevant data into a graph and/or a table.
- Narrow your topic further down to a focused position, and drafted your thesis statements.



Toy project: Explain a fraction of your culture

In our class, culture refers to everything in the everyday life of you and your neighbors.

It can be:

- pani puri stations around every corner from your hometown
- residents' survival skills on regularly jam-packed roads at 5-8 pm
- an annual parade celebrating a special day or honoring a figure
- an interesting word in your language that refers to a concept that many other languages do not have a word for.

Individual work before group activity

If you are asked to explain a cultural aspect you grew up with, what would you choose? Imagine your audience are not so familiar with it.

Is it a fact, a concept, a principle, a procedure, a process, or some mixture of these?

Consider one or two (3 minutes), and sort out main points you want to deliver (4 minutes). You can use search engines for extra information.

Group activity

Each member takes 3-4 minutes for their turn.

In your turn, share what cultural aspect you chose.

The other members actively listen and help out in searching for relevant information or further developing the direction.

Debrief

We are very much interested in your culture! Did you like your group members' topic?

What did you choose? What details would you like to explain?

What kinds of help have you given or received?

In this module

We will practice explaining multiple topics about your life.

The scope and range of the topic may change over time. It is important to start from somewhere.

Your end-of-the-module project will contain explanation of a daily routine of yours with collected data and their visualization. Find the instruction in your Google Classroom for more details.